



The partition table

5.5.2 Installing Applications

Installing applications is a breeze on Debian, and dependencies are resolved easily. All the packages are pre-compiled, and .deb packages are the most common packages for Linux software on the internet, after tarballs. If you are familiar with Ubuntu, you will be as comfortable with Debian. Just fire up the Synaptic package manager, select a list of software you want to install, and click on “Apply”.

The number one reason for using Debian is the wide support for packages. Debian is a very good option for offices that have to install a Linux distro on a number of machines. Using the 5 DVD version of Debian is a great option here. However, for home users, Linux Mint is a much better choice, with all the benefits of Debian and some more. Linux Mint supports the entire repository of Debian, as well as Ubuntu, and its own repositories.

Debian is also suited for those who plan to use a machine for a long time, say over two years. This is because of the development cycle of Debian, which essentially works as Ubuntu’s LTS (long time support) version. Both Linux Mint and Ubuntu are updated many times in a year, and downloading and installing the newer versions can be a pain, especially if you do not have a great internet connection.